Waldorf Handwork Supplies by Grade

A shop-once-a-year reference · needle sizes & weights are flexible (lighter yarn → smaller needle)

Core kit — useful every year

- [ ] Sharp fabric scissors + small thread snips
- [ ] Blunt yarn / darning needles (to sew up knitting)
- [ ] Wool batt or roving for stuffing
- [ ] Handwork / project bag (often finger-knitted in Gr. 1)
- [ ] Beeswax block (to smooth hand-made needles)
- [ ] 100% wool yarn in strong, pure colors (avoid grey-muted)

Grade 1 — Knitting (two needles)

First projects + making their own needles.

- [ ] US size 10 (6 mm) wooden knitting needles
- [ ] ¼" hardwood dowels + wooden beads (to make needles)
- [ ] Sculpey/clay for needle-end bobbles
- [ ] Bulky 100% wool yarn (e.g. Lamb's Pride Bulky)
- [ ] Chipboard scrap (pompom template)

Grade 2 — Knitting + crochet

Rainbow ball, purling, first knitted doll.

- [ ] Size 10 needles + bulky wool (as Gr. 1)
- [ ] Six rainbow colors: red, orange, yellow, green, blue, purple
- [ ] Crochet hook, US H/8 (5 mm)
- [ ] Holland wool felt + skin-tone felt (doll)
- [ ] Yarn scraps for doll hair

Grade 3 — Weaving, fiber, candles

Shelter / farming / clothing block.

- [ ] Frame or lap loom (e.g. Harrisville), or sturdy chipboard for DIY loom
- [ ] Cotton warp string + shuttle / pick-up stick
- [ ] Bulky yarn (dyeable, undyed)
- [ ] Natural dye stuff: onion skins, avocado pits, black tea
- [ ] Beeswax sheets or block + wicking (candle dipping)

Grade 4 — Embroidery, cross-stitch, felting

Wet + needle felting, decorative stitching.

- [ ] Wool roving / batt (wet & needle felting)
- [ ] Felting needles + foam pad
- [ ] Dish soap, two bowls, towel (wet felting)
- [ ] DMC embroidery floss (multi-color pack)
- [ ] Holland wool felt + sharp embroidery needles
- [ ] Even-weave / aida cloth (cross-stitch)

Grade 5 — Knitting in the round

Hats & socks on double-pointed needles.

- [ ] Set of 5 double-pointed needles, US 7–10
- [ ] or hardwood dowels + sandpaper (several grits) to make DPNs
- [ ] Bulky / worsted wool yarn
- [ ] Stitch markers (or scrap contrasting yarn)

Grade 6 — 3-D sewn felt animals

Design & hand-sew; intro to pattern-making.

- [ ] Wool / Holland felt in several colors
- [ ] Embroidery floss + embroidery needles + pins
- [ ] Wool batt stuffing
- [ ] Plain paper + pencil (drafting patterns)

Grade 7 — Fine hand-sewing / dolls

Hand-sewn items, doll & doll clothes.

- [ ] Cotton / wool fabric + matching thread
- [ ] Sharp hand-sewing needles, pins, thimble
- [ ] Doll kit: skin fabric, wool stuffing, mohair/yarn hair

Grade 8 — Machine sewing

Following a pattern on a machine; bookbinding.

- [ ] Sewing machine + universal needles + bobbins
- [ ] Cotton fabric, thread, simple garment pattern
- [ ] Measuring tape, fabric chalk, pins
- [ ] Bookbinding: paper, awl, linen thread, glue, board

Vendors often used: A Child's Dream · Harrisville Designs · WEBS (yarn.com) · plus local craft stores. Wool is preferred over cotton in the younger grades.